



THE UNIVERSITY OF BRITISH COLUMBIA
Faculty of Forestry

Dear Editorial Office,

I am writing to request a waiver of the article processing charges associated with the Brief Report entitled “Solstice optimizes thermal growing season” (2025-06796R).

This research was conducted during a short-term visit I undertook in August 2024 while I was still a PhD student. My visit was supported by a small travel grant intended to facilitate international collaboration for young researchers (grant EXPLORE6, funded by University of Montpellier). While the grant covered travel and living expenses (for a total amount of €5,196.16—see letter of grant acceptance attached, in French), it did not include any support for publication costs.

The project was not attached to any larger grant, and my PhD fellowship only covered my salary as a PhD student for three years. The host university (University of British Columbia) that welcomed me during my stay also does not have dedicated funding to support publication fees.

Given these circumstances, I am currently unable to cover the APC. I would be sincerely grateful if the journal could consider a waiver of the publication fees, so that the results of this project may be made accessible to the research community.

Please do not hesitate to contact me if you need any additional information to support this request. I sincerely thank you for your consideration and understanding.

Sincerely,

A handwritten signature in blue ink that reads 'V. Van der Meersch'.

Victor Van der Meersch, PhD
Forest & Conservation Sciences
University of British Columbia